

Option 4A: Regenerating Places

Overview

Local places vary economically and socially with change driven by local, national and global processes. These processes include movements of people, capital, information and resources, making some places economically dynamic while other places appear to be marginalised. This creates and exacerbates considerable economic and social inequalities both between and within local areas. Urban and rural regeneration programmes involving a range of players involve both place making (regeneration) and place marketing (rebranding). Regeneration programmes impact variably on people both in terms of their lived experience of change and their perception and attachment to places. The relative success of regeneration and rebranding for individuals and groups depends on the extent to which lived experience, perceptions, and attachments to places are changed.

Students should begin by studying the place in which they live or study in order to look at economic change and social inequalities. They will then put this local place in context in order to understand how regional, national, international and global influences have led to changes there. They should then study one further contrasting place through which they will develop their wider knowledge and understanding about how places change and are shaped. Both the local place and the contrasting place should be a locality, a neighbourhood or a small community, either urban or rural.

Content

Enquiry question 1: How and why do places vary?

An in-depth study of the local place in which you live or study and one contrasting place

Key idea	Detailed content
4A.1 Economies can be classified in different ways and vary from place to place.	a. Economic activity can be classified by sector (primary, secondary, tertiary and quaternary) and also by type of employment (part-time/full-time, temporary/permanent, employed/self-employed).
	b. There are differences in economic activity (employment data and output data) and this is reflected through variation in social factors (health, life expectancy and levels of education). (1)
	c. The inequalities in pay levels across economic sectors and in different types of employment are reflected in quality of life indices.

Enquiry question 1: How and why do places vary?

An in-depth study of the local place in which you live or study and one contrasting place

Key idea	Detailed content
4A.2 Places have changed their function and characteristics over time.	a. Over time, places have changed their functions (administrative, commercial, retail and industrial) and demographic characteristics (gentrification, age structure and ethnic composition).
	b. Reason for changes in a place might be explained by physical factors, accessibility and connectedness, historical development and the role of local and national planning. (2)
	c. Change can be measured using employment trends, demographic changes, land use changes and levels of deprivation (income deprivation, employment deprivation, health deprivation, crime, quality of the living environment, abandoned and derelict land). (3)
4A.3 Past and present connections have shaped the economic and social characteristics of your chosen places.	a. Global, international, national and regional influences have shaped the characteristics of your chosen places. (P: increasing roles of TNCs and IGOs)
	b. Your chosen places can be represented in a variety of different forms, giving contrasting images to those presented more formally and statistically (7).
	c. How the lives of students and others have been influenced by continuity and change in the economic and social characteristics of your chosen places. (4) (A: Attitudes on changes range from cultural erosion to enrichment)

Enquiry question 2: Why might regeneration be needed?

Key idea	Detailed content
4A.4 Economic and social inequalities change people's perceptions of an area.	a. Successful regions (🌐 Palo Alto and 'Silicon Valley') have high rates of employment, inward migration (internal and international) and low levels of multiple deprivation but also high property prices and skill shortages in both urban and rural areas.
	b. In some regions (🌐 The Rust Belt, USA) economic restructuring has triggered a spiral of decline, which includes increasing levels of social deprivation (education, health, crime, access to services and living environment) in both deindustrialised urban areas and rural settlements once dominated by primary economic activities.
	c. There are variations in the perceived need for regeneration due to significant differences in economic and social inequalities in both urban and rural locations.
4A.5 There are significant variations in the lived experience of place and engagement with them.	a. There are wide variations in levels of engagement in local communities (local and national election turnout, development and support for local community groups). (A: local communities vary in attitudes)
	b. Lived experience of, and attachment to, places varies according to age, ethnicity, gender, length of residence (new migrants, students) and levels of deprivation; these in turn impact on levels of engagement. (A: attachment to places influence attitudes)
	c. Conflicts can occur among contrasting groups in communities that have different views about the priorities and strategies for regeneration. These differences have complex causes including economic and social inequalities, lack of political engagement and representation. (P: players vary in attitudes (A) and may have contrasting priorities (F))
4A.6 There is a range of ways to evaluate the need for regeneration.	a. The use of statistical evidence to determine the need for regeneration in your chosen local place. (5)
	b. Different media can provide contrasting evidence, questioning the need for regeneration in your chosen local place. (6)
	c. How different representations of your chosen local place could influence the perceived need for regeneration. (7)

Enquiry question 3: How is regeneration managed?

Key idea	Detailed content
4A.7 UK government policy decisions play a key role in regeneration.	a. Infrastructure investment (high speed rail, airport development) in order to maintain growth and improve accessibility to regenerate regions. (P: national government facilitates regeneration, often in partnerships with charities and developers)
	b. Rate and type of development (planning laws, house building targets, housing affordability) affecting economic regeneration of both rural and urban regions. (A: government actions may prioritise national over local needs and opinions.)
	c. UK government decisions about international migration and the deregulation of capital markets (🌐 enabling foreign investment in prime London real estate) have significant impacts on the potential for growth and both direct and indirect investment. (P: government may create open or closed doors policies)
4A.8 Local government policies aim to represent areas as being attractive for inward investment.	a. Local governments compete to create sympathetic business environments with local plans designating areas for development for a range of domestic and foreign investors (🌐 Science and technology parks). (A: the actions of local authorities will affect their success)
	b. Local interest groups (Chambers of Commerce, local preservation societies, trade unions) play a key role in decision-making about regeneration; there are often tensions between groups that wish to preserve environments and those that seek change. (🌐 London Olympics 2012) (A: differing attitudes may cause conflicts)
	c. Urban and rural regeneration strategies include retail-led plans, tourism, leisure and sport (🌐 London Olympics 2012), public/private rural diversification (🌐 Powys Regeneration Partnership).
4A.9 Rebranding attempts to represent areas as being more attractive by changing public perception of them.	a. Rebranding involves re-imaging places using a variety of media to improve the image of both urban and rural locations and make them more attractive for potential investors.
	b. For UK deindustrialised cities, rebranding can stress the attraction of places, creating specific place identity building on their industrial heritage; this can attract national and international tourists and visitors (🌐 Glasgow 'Scotland with Style'). (8)
	c. There are a range of rural rebranding strategies in the post-production countryside based on heritage and literary associations, farm diversification and specialised products, outdoor pursuits and adventure in both accessible and remote areas; these strategies are intended to make these places more attractive to national and international tourists and visitors (🌐 'Brontë country', Kielder Forest).

Enquiry question 4: How successful is regeneration?

Key idea	Detailed content
4A.10 Assessing the success of regeneration uses a range of measures: economic, demographic, social and environmental.	a. The success of economic regeneration can be assessed using measures of income, poverty and employment (both relative and absolute changes) both within areas and by comparison to other more successful areas. b. Social progress can be measured by reductions in inequalities both between areas and within them; social progress can also be measured by improvements in social measures of deprivation and in demographic changes (improvements in life expectancy and reductions in health deprivation). c. Regeneration is successful if it leads to an improvement in the living environment (levels of pollution reduced, reduction in abandoned and derelict land). (9)
4A.11 Different urban stakeholders have different criteria for judging the success of urban regeneration.	a. A study of the strategies used in the regeneration of an urban place (📍 Salford Quays) and the contested nature of these decisions within local communities. (10) (A: attitudes will include NIMBYism) b. The changes that have taken place as a consequence of national and local strategies can be judged using a range of economic, social, demographic and environmental variables in an urban area. (F: future success depends on past decisions) c. Different stakeholders (local and national governments, local businesses and residents) will assess success using contrasting criteria; their views will depend on the meaning and lived experiences of an urban place and the impact of change on both the reality and the image of that place.
4A.12 Different rural stakeholders have different criteria for judging the success of rural regeneration.	a. A study of the strategies used in the restructuring of a rural place (📍 North Antrim coast) and the contested nature of these decisions within local communities. b. The changes that have taken place as a consequence of national and local strategies can be judged using a range of economic, social, demographic and environmental variables in a rural area. (F: future success depends on past decisions) c. Different stakeholders (local and national governments, local businesses and residents) will assess success using contrasting criteria; their views will depend on the meaning and lived experiences of a rural place and the impact of change on both the reality and the image of that place.

Guidance for integrating geographical skills for Topic 4 Option 4A

Quantitative and qualitative geographical skills must be developed in this topic. Particular weight must be given to qualitative approaches involved in representing place, and to analysing critically the impacts of different media on place meanings and perceptions. The use of geospatial data must also be used to present place characteristics. The following guidance on integrating geographical skills gives suggestions for opportunities to meet these requirements.

These skills are **not** exclusive to the topic areas under which they appear; students will need to be able to apply these skills across any suitable topic area throughout their course of study. *Appendix 1* outlines the full range of geographical skills.

- (1) Use of GIS to represent data about place characteristics.
- (2) Interpretation of oral accounts of the values and lived experiences of places from different interest groups and ethnic communities.
- (3) Use of Index of Multiple Deprivation (IMD) database to understand variations in levels and types of deprivation.
- (4) Investigation of social media to understand how people relate to the places where they live.
- (5) Testing of the strength of relationships through the use of scatter graphs and Spearman's rank correlation.
- (6) Use of different newspaper sources to understand conflicting views about plans for regeneration.
- (7) Evaluation of different sources (music, photography, film, art, literature) and appreciation of why they create different representations and image of a local place.
- (8) Exploration of discursive/creative media sources to find out how place identity has been used as part of rebranding.
- (9) The interpretation of photographic and map evidence showing 'before and after' cross-sections of regenerated urban and rural places.
- (10) Interrogation of blog entries and other social media to understand different views of the success of regeneration projects.

Topic 4: Shaping Places

Option 4B: Diverse Places

Overview

Local places vary both demographically and culturally with change driven by local, national and global processes. These processes include movements of people, capital, information and resources, making some places more demographically and culturally heterogeneous while other places appear to be less dynamic. This creates and exacerbates considerable social inequalities both between and within local areas.

Variations in past and present connections with places lead to very different lived experiences of places at a local level. This is because demographic and cultural changes impact variably on people in terms of the lived experience of change and their perception of and attachment to places. The relative success of the management of demographic and cultural changes for individuals and groups depends on that lived experience of change and how perceptions of, and attachments to, the place are changed.

Students should begin by studying the place in which they live or study in order to look at demographic and social changes. They will then put this local place in context in order to understand how regional, national, international and global influences have led to changes in this place. They should then study one further contrasting place, which will develop wider knowledge and understanding about how places change and are shaped. Both the local place and the contrasting place should be a locality, a neighbourhood or a small community, either urban or rural.

Content

Enquiry question 1: How do population structures vary?

An in-depth study of the local place in which you live or study and one contrasting place

Key idea	Key idea
4B.1 Population structure varies from place to place and over time.	a. The population of the UK has grown unevenly in the last 50 years, with some regions growing rapidly (🌐 London and the south-east) whilst others have grown more slowly (🌐 the north-east of England).
	b. Population structure and density varies according to placement in the rural-urban continuum and, therefore accessibility, physical factors, historical development and the role of planning.
	c. Population structure and dynamics are a result of differences in fertility and mortality rates as well as international and internal migration.

Enquiry question 1: How do population structures vary?

An in-depth study of the local place in which you live or study and one contrasting place

Key idea	Detailed content
4B.2 Population characteristics vary from place to place and over time.	a. There can be considerable variation in population characteristics (gender and ethnicity), both in and between settlements.
	b. Different levels of cultural diversity in places can be explained by social clustering, accessibility to key cities, physical factors and government planning policy. (A: actions by governments may foster or suppress diversity)
	c. Fertility and mortality rates, as well as international and internal migration, are changing the cultural characteristics of places.
4B.3 How past and present connections have shaped the demographic and cultural characteristics of your chosen places.	a. Global, international, national and regional influences have shaped the characteristics of your chosen places. (P: increasing roles of TNCs and IGOs)
	b. Your chosen places can be represented in a variety of different forms, giving contrasting images to those presented more formally and statistically. (7)
	c. How the lives of students and others have been influenced by continuity and change in the demographic and cultural characteristics of your chosen places. (1)

Enquiry question 2: How do different people view diverse living spaces?

Key idea	Detailed content
4B.4 Urban places are seen differently by different groups because of their lived experience of places and their perception of those places.	a. During industrialisation, urban places were perceived by some as dangerous and threatening (📍 Victorian London); currently they could be seen as attractive because of their range of economic opportunities and the variety of social and leisure activities that attract young people and migrants.
	b. Some urban locations are perceived as undesirable by residents and/or outsiders due to crime rates, environmental quality, population characteristics and reputation, based on quantitative data but also due to lived experience and media representation. (2)
	c. Suburban and inner-city areas are perceived differently in terms of their desirability as places to live and work by contrasting demographic groups (by age, ethnicity, life-cycle stage). (3) (A: attitudes may vary)
4B.5 Rural places are seen differently by different groups because of their lived experience of places and their perception of those places.	a. Rural places are often perceived as idyllic because of their tranquillity, natural landscapes and historical and cultural associations (📍 Hardy's 'Wessex'). (4) (A: urban and rural residents may differ in their attitude to places)
	b. Some rural locations are perceived as undesirable by residents and/or outsiders because of remoteness, limited social opportunities, limited range of services, high transport costs, population characteristics and reputation based on quantitative data but also because of lived experience and media representation.
	c. Rural areas are viewed in different ways: from very remote areas to retirement villages and commuter villages. (A: attitudes may vary)
4B.6 There is a range of ways to evaluate how people view their living spaces.	a. The use of statistical evidence to determine whether people have a positive or negative image of your chosen local place. (5)
	b. Different media can provide contrasting evidence about the image different people have of your chosen local place.
	c. How different representations of your chosen local place could be used to influence the perception of cultural and demographic issues and conflict. (6)

Enquiry question 3: Why are there demographic and cultural tensions in diverse places?

Key idea	Detailed content
4B.7 Culture and society is now more diverse in the UK.	a. Significant internal movement of people within the UK has created uneven demographic and cultural patterns. (🌐 London and the south-east)
	b. Culture and society in the UK has changed because of significant international migration flows from former colonies (🌐 Indian sub-continent and the West Indies) and from the European Union. (P: the main gatekeeper player affecting flows is the Government)
	c. Some international migrants choose to live in rural areas for specific reasons, creating social challenges and opportunities. (🌐 East Europeans in Lincolnshire)
4B.8 Levels of segregation reflect cultural, economic and social variation and change over time.	a. International migrants tend to live in distinctive places with segregation closely related to economic indicators (income and employment) and social indicators (health, crime, ethnicity and education). (7)
	b. Diverse living spaces in urban areas have social characteristics that reflect ethnicity and culture in terms of distinctive retail outlets, places of worship and leisure. (🌐 Southall) (8)
	c. Experiences and perceptions of living spaces change over generations as communities have evolved economically and culturally. (A: intergenerational attitudes and norms may change from global cultural trends)
4B.9 Changes to diverse places can lead to tension and conflict.	a. Different community groups, local and national governments and TNCs may make changes to land uses that create challenges and opportunities for local people and their lived experience of place. (A: different actions may have different impacts)
	b. There are sometimes tensions over the diversity of living spaces, especially between long-term residents who seek continuity and recent in-migrants who may seek change. (9) (🌐 Luton)
	c. Changes to the built environment will bring benefits to some groups but can provoke hostility from other groups that perceive migrants as a threat to their culture. Migrants may experience a sense of social exclusion. (🌐 Glasgow) (P: planners and developers may make controversial decisions)

Enquiry question 4: How successfully are cultural and demographic issues managed?

Key idea	Detailed content
4B.10 The management of cultural and demographic issues can be measured using a range of techniques.	a. Management can be assessed using measures of income and employment (both relative and absolute changes) both in areas and by comparison to other areas. b. Social progress can be measured by reductions in inequalities both between areas and within them as well as improvements in social measures of deprivation and demographic changes (improvements in life expectancy). (8) c. Integration of different cultures can be measured by levels of political engagement through voter turnout, the development of local community groups and reductions in 'hate' crime and racism.
4B.11 Different urban stakeholders have different criteria for assessing the success of managing change in diverse urban communities.	a. A study of the contrasting ways in which different demographic and ethnic groups view an urban living space and the impact of national and local strategies in resolving issues (🌐 <i>Aik Saath</i> in Slough). b. The changes that have taken place can be judged using a range of economic, social, demographic and environmental variables in the changing urban area. (F: changes may create differing legacies) c. Different stakeholders (local and national governments, local businesses and residents) will assess success using contrasting criteria depending on their role, the meaning of the place and the impact of change on both the reality and their image of that place. (10) (A: 'success' depends on the attitudes of different players)
4B.12 Different rural stakeholders have different criteria for assessing the success of managing change in diverse rural communities.	a. A study of the contrasting ways in which different demographic and ethnic groups view a rural living space and the impact of national and local strategies on a rural area (🌐 Lake District National Park Partnership). b. The changes that have taken place can be judged using a range of economic, social, demographic and environmental variables in the changing rural area. (F: changes may create differing legacies) c. Different stakeholders (local and national governments, local businesses and residents) will assess success using contrasting criteria, depending on the meaning of the place and the impact of change on both the reality and their image of that place. (A: 'success' depends on the attitudes of different players)

Guidance for integrating geographical skills for Topic 4 Option 4B

Quantitative and qualitative geographical skills must be developed in this topic. Particular weight must be given to qualitative approaches involved in representing place and to critically analysing the impacts of different media on place meanings and perceptions. The use of geospatial data must also be used to present place characteristics. The following guidance on integrating geographical skills gives suggestions for opportunities to meet these requirements.

These skills are **not** exclusive to the topic areas under which they appear; students will need to be able to apply these skills across any suitable topic area throughout their course of study. *Appendix 1* outlines the full range of geographical skills.

- (1) Investigation of social media to understand how people relate to the places where they live.
- (2) Use of GIS to represent and analyse crime data and to show variations in levels of crime across communities.
- (3) Interviews with local residents to interpret information representing cultural and demographic issues in a local place.
- (4) Interpretation of qualitative information (advertising copy, tourist agency material, local art exhibitions) to show both its significance and what it means about a chosen local place.
- (5) Testing of the strength of relationships through the use of scattergraphs and Spearman's rank correlation.
- (6) Evaluation of different sources (music, photography, film, art, literature) and appreciation of why they create different representations and image of a local place.
- (7) Use of indexes to measure ethnic and cultural diversity.
- (8) Interpretation of photographic and map evidence showing 'before and after' cross-sections.
- (9) Interpretation of oral accounts of the values and lived experiences of places from different interest groups and ethnic communities.
- (10) Analysis of contrasting newspaper reports about a change, including opinions about that change.

Area of study 3: Physical Systems and Sustainability